

"Dell has been working with Canonical on Ubuntu Core for over a year, and our Dell Edge Gateways are fully-certified for Ubuntu Core 16. This enables Dell to offer the long-term support and security that IoT use cases such as factory and building automation demand," said Jason Shepherd, director of strategy and partnerships for IoT, Dell, in a statement.

Linux has so far been the first choice for IoT device manufacturers. However, some serious issues emerged recently as warning against untested deployments. The Mirai botnet surfaced in October this year, and exposed thousands of connected devices to DDoS (distributed denial of service) attacks. Most recently, NyaDrop emerged, which loads malware on hardware such as DVRs and CCTV cameras.

Ubuntu Core is one of the popular solutions for devices ranging from top-of-the-rack switches and industrial gateways, to radio access networks, digital signages, robots and drones. Thus, its upgrade would bring enhancements onto a variety of devices and enable refined security across the entire IoT ecosystem.

Alfresco Activiti 1.5 comes with extensive data modelling

Alfresco Software has released the Alfresco Activiti 1.5 business process management (BPM) solution. The new update comes with extensive data



modelling features and offers one-click access to connected databases.

To improve Big Data developments, Alfresco Activiti 1.5 includes support for external data sources. Users can also

leverage the integrated enterprise content management (ECM) systems such as Alfresco One to fulfil their data requirements. Additionally, there is an option to 'persist' the changing data on their records and even keep a changelog for the underlying database.

"It is a basic tenet of our design philosophy that an inherently powerful, full-featured but complex application must be made easy to architect by non-professional developers. That is what we have accomplished with Alfresco Activiti 1.5 – allowing developers of all levels to tap content to enrich existing or new business processes," said Paul Hampton, senior director of product marketing, Alfresco, in a statement.

The latest Alfresco Activiti includes integral content rule functions from Alfresco One to allow users to develop automated rules that will alter content under specific, pre-stated conditions. App developers can utilise content management features on the Alfresco platform by using the flexible design of the updated BPM tool. There is also a rich documentation functionality to let users document the content and flow of business processes.

Analysts believe that Alfresco Activity is a 'rising star' in the IT market, as it offers flexible design and many integration capabilities. "We are seeing accelerating interest among enterprises to automate as many processes as feasible – especially IT related processes, a trend that bodes well for both open source and vendor sponsored business process engines," stated Carl Lehmann, principal analyst for enterprise architecture and process management at 451 Research.

Developers can access the advanced features of Alfresco Activiti 1.5 either on-premises or via a private cloud. It is available for a 30-day trial through the official site.

HTML 5.1 is now the latest Web standard

The World Wide Consortium (W3C) has released the official HTML 5.1 specification. The new release is the first minor revision of the fifth major version of the Hypertext Markup Language (HTML) that is being widely used across Web apps.

"In this version, new features continue to be introduced to help Web application authors, new elements continue to be introduced based on research into prevailing authoring practices, and special attention continues to be given to define clear conformance criteria for user agents in an effort to improve interoperability," the W3C team wrote in a blog post.



Unlike its previous version that debuted in 2014, HTML 5.1 is not a big release. However, it brings some new attributes and elements such as `srcset`, `<picture>`, `<summary>` and `type="context"`. The newest revision also comes with the requestAnimationFrame API to enhance Web animation effects.

Alongside the new additions, the upgraded HTML standard includes tweaks such as nested `<header>` and `<footer>` elements, and the optional `url=` attribute. The consortium has removed some old features, like media controllers and command API.

W3C plans to bring out the HTML 5.2 recommendation sometime in late 2017. In the meantime, developers can start testing the features of HTML 5.1.